
Chapter 1: Installation Prerequisites for Windows

This document describes the prerequisite steps necessary to correctly install and configure all Ansys, Inc. products on Windows platforms for Release 2026 R1. To view a complete list of the products available, see [Applications Included with Each Product \(p. ?\)](#).

Note:

Ansys Workbench is installed by default as product components to most Ansys, Inc. products. Ansys Workbench is not installed as part of the products under Ansys Additional Tools, nor with the CFD-Post only option. Ansys Workbench includes the following applications:

- The Mechanical application
- DesignModeler
- DesignXplorer
- Meshing
- Remote Solve Manager
- Fluent Meshing
- EKM Client
- Granta EduPack
- Granta Selector
- Minerva
- SpaceClaim Direct Modeler

Caution:

While **SpaceClaim Direct Modeler** and **Ansys SpaceClaim** can be installed on the same computer, only one of the applications can be configured with Ansys Workbench at any given time. Users can choose which version to configure via the CAD Configuration Manager utility.

- SpaceClaim CATIA V5 Interface
- ECAD

Because some of these applications can be run as standalone applications without Ansys Workbench, you will see some but not all of these listed separately as options when you uninstall. In such cases, you will need to select those options in order to uninstall those components.

Where supported, IGES and STEP Geometry Interfaces will be installed.

Some procedures apply only to specific products and are so noted.

Important Notice

If you want to run multiple releases of Ansys, Inc. software, you **MUST** install them chronologically (for example., Release 2025 R2 followed by Release 2026 R1). If you install an earlier release after installing Release 2026 R1, you will encounter licensing issues that may prevent you from running any products/releases. If you need to install an earlier release after you have already installed Release 2026 R1, you **MUST** uninstall Release 2026 R1, then re-install the releases in order.

Summary of New and Changed Features

The following features are new or changed at Release 2026 R1. Review these items carefully.

- For this release, the Ansys installation program has added the following products:
 - 3D Design
 - Headless Geometry Service (PyAnsysGeometry)
 - AI Tools
 - Actionable Language Interface (ALI)
 - Embedding Model BGE-M3
 - Connect
 - Behavior Execution Engine
 - System Architecture Modeler (SAM)
 - optiSLang Core Headless
 - optiSLang Core UI
 - Electronics
 - Motor-CAD
 - PerceiveEM
 - Embedded Software
 - Scade One

- SCADE Rapid Prototyper
- Fluids
 - RBF Morph Fluids
- Structures
 - RBF Morph Structures
- Need for PAC file, and its URL, are automatically detected from operating system settings.

1.1. System Prerequisites

Ansys 2026 R1 is supported on the following Windows platforms and operating system levels. For up-to-date information on hardware platforms or operating systems that have been certified, see the [Platform Support section of the Ansys Website](#).

Table 1.1: Supported Windows Platforms

Processor	Operating System	Platform architecture (directory name)	Availability
x64 (64-bit)	Windows 11 (Professional, Enterprise & Education), Windows Server 2022 Standard, Windows Server 2025 Standard	winx64	Download, USB
Note: Home editions of Windows operating systems are not supported.			
For detailed and current support information, see the Platform Support section of the Ansys Website .			

Supported Products By Platform

For a complete list of products supported by each platform, see the **Platform Support by Application** PDF on the [Platform Support section of the Ansys Website](#).

Supported Platforms for High Performance Computing

See the discussions on [Configuring Distributed Ansys](#) and [Configuring Ansys CFX Parallel](#) for detailed information on supported platforms for distributed computing.

1.1.1. CAD Support

The following CAD and auxiliary programs are supported on the indicated products and platforms (where the CAD product is supported on the noted platforms). Products are:

A = Mechanical APDL

W = Ansys Workbench

I = Ansys ICEM CFD (standalone and Ansys Workbench Readers)

S = Ansys Speos

Table 1.2: CAD Plugin Support by Platform

Product	Windows 11
ACIS 2024	A, W
Autodesk AutoCAD 2026	W, I
Autodesk AutoCAD 2025	W, I
Autodesk Inventor 2026	
Autodesk Inventor 2025	
CATIA 4.2.4	A, W
CATIA V5–6R2024	A, W
CATIA V5 (CADNexus CAPRI CAE Gateway V4.10.0) V5–6R2023, V5-6R2024, V5–6R2025	
CATIA V6 R2024x	W, I
Creo Elements/Direct Modeling 20.8	
Creo Elements/Direct Modeling 20.7	
Creo Parametric 12.4	A, W, I, S
Creo Parametric 11.0	A, W, I, S
Creo Parametric 10.0	A, W, I, S
Creo Parametric 9.0	A, W, I, S
Fusion 2.0.15995 onward	W
GEMS	
IDI MS8/9	
IGES 3	W
JT 10.8	W
Parasolid 35.1	W
NX 2312 6, 2406 6, 2412 6, 2506 6	W, S
Rhinoceros 8.0	W
Solid Edge 2026	W, I
Solid Edge 2025	W, I
SOLIDWORKS 2024	W
SOLIDWORKS 2023	W
SOLIDWORKS 2022	W
SOLIDWORKS 2021	
SOLIDWORKS 2020	
SpaceClaim 2020	
STEP AP203, AP214, AP242	

1. For ICEM CFD standalone, ACIS 18.0.1 is the supported version for all platforms.

2. Requires V5-6R2016 or later.
3. IGES Versions 4.0, 5.2, and 5.3 are supported.
4. Professional, Education and Enterprise
5. Requires operating system's Anniversary Update version 1607 or higher
6. Microsoft Visual C++ Redistributable 2019 x64 required.
7. **Table 1.3: CAD Reader Support by Platform**

Product	Windows 11
CATIA Reader 4	A, W
CATIA Reader 5	A, W
CATIA Reader 6	W, I
Creo Parametric Reader	A, W, I
NX Reader	W, S
SOLIDWORKS Reader	W
Solid Edge Reader	W, I
Autodesk Inventor Reader	
Autodesk AutoCAD Reader	W, I

Note:

View the latest supported CAD packages at [ansys.com> Solutions> Solutions by Role> IT Professionals> Platform Support> CAD Support](https://www.ansys.com/Solutions/Solutions%20by%20Role/IT%20Professionals/Platform%20Support/CAD%20Support).

1.2. Disk Space and Memory Requirements

You will need the disk space shown here for each product for installation and proper functioning. The numbers listed here are the maximum amount of disk space you will need for each Ansys, Inc. product. Depending on the options selected for each product and shared product features, you may require less disk space when installing multiple products.

Product	Disk Space (GB)
Ansys Actionable Language Interface	8.5
Ansys Additive	33.7
Ansys Aqwa	20.5
Ansys Autodyn	20.4
AVxcelerate Headlamp	16.4
AVxcelerate Headlamp Library for SCANeR	14.3
AVxcelerate Headlamp Library for CarMaker	7.0

Product	Disk Space (GB)
Ansys AVxcelerate Sensors	57.9
Ansys AVxcelerate Sensors Library for CarMaker	8.0
Ansys Behavior Execution Engine	3.9
Ansys BladeModeler	30.4
Ansys CFD-Post only	28.8
Ansys CFX	29.7
Ansys Chemkin	29.4
Ansys Customization Files for User-Programmable Features	8.1
Ansys Discovery (Reduced Install)	36.3
Ansys Discovery (Full Install)	60.3
Ansys Dynamic Reporting	31.1
Ansys Embedded Model BGE-M3	8.6
Ansys EnSight	35.5
Ansys Electromagnetics Suite	39.9
Ansys Electromagnetics RSM	3.3
Ansys FENSAP-ICE	29.7
Ansys Fluent	50.6
Ansys Forte (includes EnSight)	33.4
Ansys Geometry Interfaces	21.3
Ansys Granta EduPack	8.8
Ansys Granta Selector	8.7
Headless Geometry Service (PAnsysGeometry)	13.4
Ansys ICEM CFD	25.4
Ansys LS-DYNA	23.3
Ansys Lumerical	10.4
Ansys Lumerical-RPM	10.3
Ansys Material Calibration App	25.4
AnsysMaterial Designer	29.1
Ansys Mechanical Products	25.2
Ansys Medini Analyze	4.4
Ansys Medini Analyze QKit	3.9
Ansys ModelCenter	9.5
Ansys ModelCenter Remote Execution	4.7
Ansys ModelCenter MBSE Connector for Ansys SAM	4.1
Ansys ModelCenter MBSE Connector for Capella	3.5
Ansys ModelCenter MBSE Connector for Cameo 2019	3.5
Ansys ModelCenter MBSE Connector for Cameo 2021-2024	3.5
Ansys ModelCenter MBSE Connector for GENESYS	3.5

Product	Disk Space (GB)
Ansys ModelCenter MBSE Connector for Rhapsody	3.5
Ansys Model Fuel Library (Encrypted)	29.4
Ansys Motion	21.3
Ansys Motor-CAD	4.4
Ansys Optics Launcher	3.3
Ansys optiSLang Core AI	5.9
Ansys optiSLang AI	3.3
Ansys optiSLang App Generation	3.3
Ansys optiSLang Core Headless	3.3
Ansys PerceiveEM	3.2
Ansys Polyflow (including CFD-Post)	47.6
Ansys Reaction Workbench	29.4
Ansys Rocky	9.8
Ansys Remote Solve Manager Standalone Services	7.4
Ansys Scade One	4.1
Ansys Scade Raptic Prototyper	5.7
Ansys Sherlock	24.4
Ansys Sound: SAS	5.6
Ansys Sound - JLT	4.6
Ansys Sound - CSS	5.1
Ansys Sound - VRS	5.6
Ansys Sound - ASDfoEV	5.3
Ansys Speos	34.8
Ansys Speos Libraries	7.3
AnsysSpeos HPC	3.9
Speos for Creo Parametric 9	8.7
Speos for Creo Parametric 10	8.7
Speos for Creo Parametric 11	8.7
Speos for Creo Parametric 12	8.7
Speos for NX 2406	8.7
Speos for NX 2412	8.7
Speos for NX 2506	8.7
Speos for NX 2512	8.7
Ansys Speos RPC	4.4
Ansys System Architecture	13.1
Ansys Thermal Desktop: AutoCAD	6.3
Thermal Desktop: Thermal Desktop and TD Designer	4.6
Thermal Desktop: Sinda Solver	4.5

Product	Disk Space (GB)
Ansys TurboGrid	24.7
Ansys TwinAI	12.6
Ansys Twin Builder	40.3
Ansys Zemax OpticStudio	6.3
Disk space required to install all products	270.0

Product installations also require an additional 500 MB of free disk space during an installation.

Memory Requirements

You must have a minimum of 8 GB of memory to run product installations; 16 or 32 GB of memory is recommended.

1.3. Software Prerequisites

You must have the following software installed on your system. Administrator privileges are required to install these files. These software prerequisites are installed automatically when you launch the product installation. If, after installing the Ansys products, you need to check your system for these software prerequisites or re-install any of them at a later date, open the Product & CAD Configuration Manager and select **Check for Required Prerequisites** or **Install Required Prerequisites**.

- A minimum version of Microsoft .NET Framework 4.6.2 is required.

Note:

If your computer does not have Microsoft .NET Framework 4.6.2 installed, the installation program installs .NET 4.6.2 as a prerequisite and may require a system restart after exiting the installation and before running any Ansys products.

- Microsoft .NET Framework 4.8 is required for:
 - Ansys Discovery
 - Ansys Granta EduPack
 - Ansys Granta Selector
- Microsoft Visual C++ 2012 Redistributable (32 and 64 bit versions)
- Microsoft Visual C++ 2013 Redistributable (32 and 64 bit versions)
- Microsoft Visual C++ 2022 Redistributable (32 and 64 bit versions)

Prior to installing, you can find the executables for the software prerequisites in the root \prereq directory of the media/download package.

For additional information on Ansys Thermal Desktop and Sinda software prerequisites, see [Thermal Desktop Installation and Licensing Guide](#)

1.4. Requirements for the GPU Accelerator in the Mechanical APDL Application

Your system must meet the following requirements to use the GPU accelerator capability in Mechanical APDL. For information on the most recently tested GPU cards, see the **GPU Accelerator Capabilities** PDF on the [Platform Support section of the Ansys Website](#).

- The machine(s) being used for the simulation must contain at least one GPU card.
- A minimum 16GB of on-card memory is recommended in order to achieve meaningful acceleration in simulations that can use the GPU card.
- To achieve optimal performance, only GPU cards with significant double precision performance (FP64) are recommended for use with the sparse direct solver and eigensolvers based on the sparse solver (for example, Block Lanczos or subspace). The following cards are recommended:

Card ^[b]	GPU Information ^[a]				Recommended Equation Solvers		
	Release Year	FP64 and FP32 Performance (TFLOPS)	Memory Capacity (GB)	Memory Bandwidth (GB/sec)	Sparse (Direct)	Iterative (PCG, etc.)	Mixed
Data Center Cards							
NVIDIA B300 ^[c]	2025	75/1.2	270 GB	7,700 GB/s	Y	Y	Y
NVIDIA B200	2025	80/40	186 GB	7,700 GB/s	Y	Y	Y
NVIDIA B100	2025	__ ^[d]	__ ^[d]	__ ^[d]	Y	Y	Y
NVIDIA H200	2024	34/67	141 GB	4,800 GB/s	Y	Y	Y
NVIDIA H100	2022	30/60	94 GB	3,900 GB/s	Y	Y	Y
NVIDIA L40	2022	1.4/90	48 GB	864 GB/s	N	Y	Y
NVIDIA A30	2021	5.2/10.3	24 GB	933 GB/s	Y	Y	Y
NVIDIA A100	2020	9.7/19.5	80 GB	1,940 GB/s	Y	Y	Y
NVIDIA A40	2020	0.58/37	48 GB	696 GB/s	N	Y	Y
Professional Workstation Cards							
AMD Radeon AI PRO R9700	2025	1.5/47.8	32 GB	640 GB/s	N	Y	Y
AMD Ryzen AI Max+ PRO 395	2025	0.5/14.5	128 GB	256 GB/s	N	Y	Y
AMD Ryzen AI Max+ 395	2025	0.5/14.5	128 GB	256 GB/s	N	Y	Y
AMD Radeon PRO W7900	2023	1.9/61	48 GB	864 GB/s	N	Y	Y
NVIDIA RTX PRO 6000	2025	1.9/126	96 GB	1,340 GB/s	N	Y	Y
NVIDIA RTX PRO 5000	2025	1/66.5	48 GB	1,790 GB/s	N	Y	Y

NVIDIA A800	2024	9.7/19.5	40 GB	1,500 GB/s	Y	Y	Y
NVIDIA RTX 5880 Ada	2024	1.08/69	48 GB	864 GB/s	N	Y	Y
NVIDIA RTX 5000 Ada	2023	1.0/65	32 GB	576 GB/s	N	Y	Y
NVIDIA RTX 4500 Ada	2023	0.6/39	20 GB	640 GB/s	N	Y	Y
NVIDIA RTX 6000 Ada	2022	1.5/91	48 GB	960 GB/s	N	Y	Y
NVIDIA RTX A5500	2022	0.5/34	24 GB	768 GB/s	N	Y	Y
NVIDIA A16	2021	0.1/4.5	16 GB	200 GB/s	N	Y	Y
NVIDIA A10	2021	1/31	24 GB	600 GB/s	N	Y	Y
NVIDIA RTX A5000	2021	0.5/27	24 GB	768 GB/s	N	Y	Y
NVIDIA RTX A4500	2021	0.3/23	24 GB	640 GB/s	N	Y	Y
NVIDIA RTX A4000	2021	0.3/19	16 GB	448 GB/s	N	Y	Y
NVIDIA RTX A6000	2020	0.6/38	48 GB	768 GB/s	N	Y	Y
Consumer Cards ^[e]							
NVIDIA GeForce RTX 5090	2025	1.6/104	32 GB	1790 GB/s	N	Y	Y
NVIDIA GeForce RTX 5080	2025	0.8/56	16 GB	960 GB/s	N	Y	Y
NVIDIA GeForce RTX 5070 Ti	2025	0.7/44	16 GB	896 GB/s	N	Y	Y

- [a] The hardware specifications in this table are based on publicly available product datasheets and vendor documentation. Specifications may change or contain inaccuracies. Verify all details with the official manufacturer resources before making decisions.
- [b] GPUs that are unreleased at the time of this software release are not listed in this table. These GPUs may still be compatible with this release, but their performance and functionality have not been validated.
- [c] Hardware specifications for NVIDIA B300 are sourced from the official NVIDIA product datasheet. For details, see <https://resources.nvidia.com/en-us-dgx-systems/dgx-b300-datasheet>.
- [d] The vendor has not declared the specification for this entry.
- [e] Consumer GPUs with 16 GB of memory offer limited performance for large-scale workloads. Their fixed memory capacity restricts acceleration compared to workstation or data center GPUs with higher memory configurations.

- For NVIDIA GPU cards, note the following:

- The Mechanical APDL software installation provides the necessary CUDA 13.0.2 libraries to accelerate the FEA solution. No separate installation of CUDA is required.
- The GPU driver is not installed by Mechanical APDL. The driver version must be 581.42 or newer. For optimal performance on Windows, the TCC (Tesla Compute Cluster) driver mode is recommended when using Tesla series GPU cards. Some limitations exist when using this driver mode. Check your GPU card documentation for more details on how to set this driver mode and the existing limitations.

3. The CUDA 13.0.2 libraries only support Visual Studio 2022 Professional.
- For AMD GPU cards, note the following:
 1. The Mechanical APDL installation provides the necessary HIP/ROCm 6.4.2 libraries to accelerate the FEA solution. No separate installation of HIP/ROCm is required. Note that your machine must have at least SUSE Linux Enterprise Server 15 SP5 to use the ROCm libraries.
 2. The GPU driver is not installed by Mechanical APDL. The driver version must be 6.4.2 or newer. Some instructions are given below.
 - the following AMD link lists their .
 - To install the AMD driver, follow the Windows installation steps on the AMD page: .
 - To utilize a GPU device that is not on the recommended list of cards, set the following environment variable:

`ANSGPU_OVERRIDE=1`

This is most beneficial when you wish to run on newer GPUs that were not available at the time of release of this version of the Ansys program. If you choose to use this environment variable, you should ensure that the GPU device that you wish to use is sufficiently powerful, in terms of both double-precision compute power and on-card memory, to achieve meaningful acceleration for your simulation. Using this environment variable with an underpowered CPU may actually decelerate your simulation.

Support for AMD GPUs released after a specific version of the Mechanical APDL application is limited due to incompatibility between required software libraries and the GPU hardware. To check which GPU architectures are supported, refer to the AMD compatibility matrix version. You can find the GPU architecture in the device's specification sheet.

- For details on HPC licensing, see [HPC Licensing in the *Parallel Processing Guide*](#).
- For details on GPU benchmarks, see [Ansys Mechanical Benchmarks](#).
- For more information about using GPUs with the Mechanical APDL application, see the following resources on the Ansys website and innovation space:
 - [What GPU Should I Use – Mechanical APDL Application](#)
 - [Enhancing Mechanical APDL™ performance with GPUs](#)

Note:

On Windows, the use of Remote Desktop may disable the use of a GPU device. Launching Mechanical APDL through the Ansys Remote Solve Manager (RSM) when RSM is installed as a service may also disable the use of a GPU. In these two scenarios, the GPU accelerator capability cannot be used. Using the TCC (Tesla Compute Cluster) driver mode, if applicable, can circumvent this restriction.

1.5. Additional Hardware and Software Requirements

- Intel 64 / AMD64 system with the correct operating system version installed
- 8 GB of RAM (Minimum)
- 128 GB free on the hard drive is recommended
- A current default web browser must be installed to view the **Ansys internet-based help documentation**.

For a complete list of supported browsers, see the **Browser Support** PDF on the [Platform Support section of the Ansys Website](#).

For a local copy of the product documentation on your system, download an installable version from the Ansys Download Center. Instructions for installing the Local Help are included with the download package.

- Discrete graphics card with the latest drivers and compatible with the supported operating systems. For full functionality, use of a recent NVIDIA Quadro or AMD FirePro card with at least 1 GB of discrete video memory and supporting OpenGL version 4.5 or above. Intel Iris Pro Integrated graphics has also been used successfully.

For information on the most recently tested graphics cards, see the **Graphics Cards Tested** PDF on the [Platform Support section of the Ansys Website](#).

For Ansys Discovery, see [Product Installation](#)

Note:

- **Vendor Legacy Support:** To be compatible, legacy GL 4.5 compliant cards should still be within the official legacy support period of their respective graphics vendor, and must still be receiving regular driver updates. Visit the appropriate vendor websites to review legacy hardware lists.
-

- A minimum screen resolution of: 1024 x 768 (4:3 aspect ratio), 1366 x 768 (16:9 aspect ratio) or 1280 x 800 (16:10 aspect ratio) with minimum 24 bit color. A higher screen resolution such as 1920x1080 (16:9) or 1920x1200 (16:10) is strongly recommended for most applications.

Note:

- Some combinations of graphics card type, operating system, and MPEG resolution fail to play MPEGs properly. You may be able to get normal playback results simply by changing the MPEG settings. Alternatively, you can upgrade your graphics card.
 - **Ultra High Definition (4K) Graphics Cards:** Use of Ultra High Definition (4K) graphics cards may cause a number of cosmetic display issues (including enlarged or reduced text and incorrect positioning of option labels). These issues do not affect the functionality of the installation program.
-

- Microsoft Mouse or a mouse. Most applications require a three-button mouse.
- If you use a 3Dconnexion product, ensure that you have the latest version of the drivers installed.
- Approximately twice as much swap space as memory. The amount of memory swap space on the system may limit the size of the Ansys model that can be created and/or solved.
- TCP/IP for the license manager (see the [Ansys Licensing Guide](#) for more information on TCP/IP).

Although TCP/IP is included as part of the operating system, it may not be installed by default. When TCP/IP is installed, it must be bound to a network adapter. On machines that are connected to an internal network, TCP/IP must be bound to a network card such as an Ethernet adapter. The vast majority of systems using TCP/IP will fall into this category. On machines that connect to the internet or corporate intranet through a modem, TCP/IP can be bound to the Remote Access Service. Also, the Autodial option of the Internet Options must be disabled so that the machine does not attempt to connect to the Internet every time Ansys is run. See the [Ansys Licensing Guide](#) for more information.

- Microsoft Internet Explorer (IE) 11 or greater is recommended for proper operation of Ansys Workbench. Once the correct version of IE is installed, it does not have to be your default Internet browser. After installation, simply run your preferred browser and reestablish it as the default.
- PDF reader software is required to read the installation guides and other user documentation.

To access our help system videos, Ansys recommends that you set Windows Media Player as your default.

1.5.1. Ansys Additive Software Requirements

The Ansys Additive application uses ports 5000, 7000, 7933, 7934, 7935, 8125, 8181, 9002, 9042, and 9711 to allow communication among the components in the application. See [Ansys Additive will not start immediately after installation \(p. ?\)](#) to troubleshoot if these ports are not open.

All other requirements for Additive are the same as the default requirements for all Ansys products.

1.5.2. Ansys AVxcelerate Sensors Software Requirements

For AVxcelerate Sensors products, additional requirements are listed in the [AVxcelerate Sensors Installation Guide](#).

1.5.3. Ansys Discovery Software Requirements

Prior to installing Discovery, verify that your installation computer meets the following prerequisites.

Operating System Requirements

One of the following:

- Microsoft® Windows 11 version 23H2 or later (Professional, Enterprise & Education)
- Microsoft® Windows Server 2022 (Standard) or Windows Server 2025 (Standard)

System Requirements

- 64-bit Intel or AMD system
- Disk Space and Memory:
 - 16 GB RAM or greater
 - 32 GB disk space

Cloud Burst Computing Requirements

Requirements for a successful burst-to-cloud experience are described in [Requirements for Cloud Burst Computing](#).

Video Card Requirements

User systems should have a dedicated graphics card for Discovery. As detailed in the table below, Discovery's minimum and recommended video card requirements differ depending on the product stage and solver being used.

For information on the most recently tested graphics cards, see the [Platform Support section of the Ansys Website](#) and view the **Graphics Cards Tested** PDF for your release.

Note:

With a 4K monitor, Ansys recommends use of a video card with more than 4 GB of dedicated video memory.

Table 1.4: Discovery Stages and Video Card Requirements

Discovery Stage and Solver	Minimum Video Card Requirements	Recommended Video Card Requirements
• Model stage	Dedicated graphics card with the latest vendor drivers supporting OpenGL version 4.6 and a minimum of 2 GB of dedicated video memory	Dedicated NVIDIA Quadro or AMD Radeon Pro graphics card with the latest vendor drivers supporting OpenGL version 4.6 and a minimum of 4 GB of dedicated video memory
• Explore stage • Refine stage with LiveGX solver	• Dedicated NVIDIA GPU, Maxwell series or newer • 4 GB of dedicated video memory Note: We recommend you update your graphics card to the latest drivers from the NVIDIA website prior to installation, with the minimum required	• Dedicated NVIDIA GPU, Pascal series or newer • 8 GB dedicated video memory Note: We recommend you update your graphics card to the latest drivers from the NVIDIA website prior to installation, with the minimum required

Discovery Stage and Solver	Minimum Video Card Requirements	Recommended Video Card Requirements
	driver version for minor version compatibility being ≥ 528.33. With AMD cards and non-compliant NVIDIA cards, Discovery still functions but access to the Explore stage, or to the Refine stage using the LiveGX solver, is disabled.	driver version for minor version compatibility being ≥ 528.33. With AMD cards and non-compliant NVIDIA cards, Discovery still functions but access to the Explore stage, or to the Refine stage using the LiveGX solver, is disabled.
• Refine stage with Fluent solver • Refine stage with MAPDL solver	Dedicated NVIDIA Quadro or AMD Radeon Pro graphics card with the latest vendor drivers supporting OpenGL version 4.6 and a minimum of 4 GB of dedicated video memory	Dedicated NVIDIA Quadro or AMD Radeon Pro graphics card with the latest vendor drivers supporting OpenGL version 4.6 and a minimum of 8 GB of dedicated video memory

Note:

You can download the latest official NVIDIA drivers from www.nvidia.com/download/index.aspx.

Unsupported Video Cards

The following cards are no longer supported at 2026 R1. In general, Discovery maintains support for as long as NVIDIA drivers and SDKs allow:

- Consumer
 - GeForce 600 series (for example, GeForce GT625)
 - NVIDIA GeForce GT 630
 - NVIDIA GeForce GT 640
 - NVIDIA GeForce GT 730

- NVIDIA GeForce GT 740
- NVIDIA GeForce GTX 645
- NVIDIA GeForce GTX 650
- NVIDIA GeForce GTX 650 Ti
- NVIDIA GeForce GTX 650 Ti Boost
- NVIDIA GeForce GTX 660
- NVIDIA GeForce GTX 660 Ti
- NVIDIA GeForce GTX 670
- NVIDIA GeForce GTX 680
- NVIDIA GeForce GTX 690
- NVIDIA GeForce GTX 760
- NVIDIA GeForce GTX 760 Ti OEM
- NVIDIA GeForce GTX 760 (192-bit)
- NVIDIA GeForce GTX 770
- NVIDIA GeForce GTX 780
- NVIDIA GeForce GTX TITAN
- ProViz
 - Quadro Kxxx series
 - Quadro 410/420
 - Quadro K600/620
 - Quadro K[1/2/4]200
 - Quadro K2000D
 - Quadro K[2/4/5]000
 - Quadro Kx000M series
 - Quadro K[1/2/3/4/5]000M
 - Quadro Kx100M series
 - Quadro K500M

→ Quadro K[1/2/3/4/5]100M

- Datacenter
 - GRID K520 (AWS EC2 g2 instance)
 - Tesla K10

Miscellaneous Requirements

- Microsoft .NET Framework 4.8
- Microsoft ASP.NET Core Runtime 8.0
- Microsoft .NET Desktop Runtime 8.0
- Microsoft .NET Runtime 8.0
- Microsoft Visual C++ 2022 x64 Redistributable
- OpenCL 1.2
- OpenGL 4.6
- Windows Media Player is required for viewing the videos that appear on the Ansys Discovery Welcome Screen

Note:

Microsoft .NET 8.0 is included with both the full and reduced Discovery installations.

Prerequisite Requirement Checking and Reporting

Upon launching Discovery after installation, prerequisite checking occurs automatically to ensure there are no installation issues that may lead to unexpected behaviors or failures. The results of these checks are reported in several ways:

- When you launch Discovery, a dialog box reports any missing or out-of-date prerequisites that were identified.
- Results of the prerequisite checks are captured in the Discovery application log.
- The SID reports any missing or out-of-date prerequisites that were identified when Discovery was launched, as well as results concerning prerequisite checking specific to the Explore and Refine stages.

Reporting Issues to Ansys Customer Support

If you encounter issues running Discovery, follow this procedure:

1. Open the Windows command prompt as administrator.
2. Run this command:

"<ansys-install-location>/Framework/bin/Win64/Ans.DriverSetup.exe" --check-system-compatibility

3. Capture the output of the command and include it, along with the Discovery application log, when contacting Ansys customer support.

1.5.4. 3Dconnexion Software Product Support

Only specific Ansys applications have been tested for manipulating the model (turning, zooming, panning, etc.) with the 3Dconnexion products. While these 3Dconnexion products do provide significantly enhanced 3D control over viewing the model, they do not function as a mouse replacement and selection operations still require a mouse. For a complete list of 3Dconnexion products certified with the current release of Ansys applications, see the **3Dconnexion Devices Certification** PDF on the [Platform Support section of the Ansys Website](#)

To use a 3Dconnexion product with the listed products, you must download and install the appropriate Microsoft Windows driver for your version of Windows. Refer to <http://www.3dconnexion.com> for more information on using Space products and to download the appropriate drivers.

Spaceball/Connexion3D functionality in Ansys Discovery

- Only the "FIT" built in function is supported.
- Most of the other operations can be simulated by mapping Connexion functions to keyboard shortcuts supported in Ansys Discovery.

1.5.5. Ansys ModelCenter Software Requirements

Important:

Uninstall any 25R1 and earlier versions of ModelCenter software before installing ModelCenter from the Ansys unified installer.

System Requirements

- GPU Hardware acceleration is required for plotting.
- One of the following must be installed before using ModelCenter products:
 - Java 8 - support is deprecated and is no longer recommended for use in production environments.
 - Java 11 LTS – fully supported
 - Java 17 LTS – fully supported
 - Java 21 LTS -- currently in Beta support. Use is permitted but should be approached with caution in critical environments.

ModelCenter MBSE Connector Prerequisites

- You must install ModelCenter to install a ModelCenter MBSE connector. ModelCenter Remote Execution is also required if you want to use MCRE components in ModelCenter MBSE.
- The related Systems Architecture Modeling (SAM) tool must be installed before installing the MBSE connector. See the ModelCenter Installation Guide for more information.
 - MagicDraw/Cameo must also be configured before the connector is installed.
 - Rhapsody – to import requirements from DOORS NG, you must select specific add-ons when installing.

1.5.6. Ansys Granta EduPack Software Requirements

The requirements for Ansys Granta EduPack are the same as the default requirements for all Ansys products, with the following exceptions:

Operating System Requirements

- Microsoft® Windows 11

1.5.7. Ansys Granta Selector Software Requirements

The requirements for Ansys Granta Selector are the same as the default requirements for all Ansys products, with the following exceptions:

Operating System Requirements

- Microsoft® Windows 11

1.5.8. Speos Software Requirements

With the exception of the graphics adapter, the requirements for Ansys Speos are the same as the default requirements for all other Ansys products. Ansys Speos requires a minimum NVIDIA A5000 graphics adapter with a 581.42 NVIDIA driver.

Note:

Ansys certifies one Nvidia driver per release for Speos. That means other or subsequent drivers are not officially supported and may not work.

Regional Settings

When using "Regional Settings>Additional Settings", you must use a dot as decimal symbol and a space as digit grouping symbol.

1.5.8.1. Speos for NX Software Requirements

To be able to use Speos for NX, during a Siemens NX installation you must install the Programming Tool module for the NX 2406 version and subsequent (NX 2412, NX 2506).

1.5.8.2. Ansys Optical Labs Software Requirements

This page presents the hardware and software requirements of the Ansys Optical Labs. The Ansys Optical Labs are exclusively integrated in Ansys SPEOS installation.

The workstation should meet or exceed the following requirements.

Graphic Adapter

Only required for 3D Energy Density Lab and Virtual Reality Lab.

Table 1.5: 3D Energy Density Lab and Virtual Reality Lab Graphics

3D Energy Density Lab	Virtual Reality Lab
- NVIDIA graphics processor - Support of OpenGL v2.1 minimum	- AMD or NVIDIA graphics processor - Support of OpenCL 1.2 minimum - Support of OpenGL v2.1 minimum SDK OpenCL is not required for GPU since it is included with the drivers. Active Stereoscopy can only be done on QUADRO and FIREPRO cards. - HDR only supports the NVIDIA graphics processor. Refer to your GPU specifications to ensure HDR compatibility.

Additional VR Lab Requirements

Examples of Speos 360 Files Memory Requirements

This table contains a list of characteristics associated to Speos 360 files and the corresponding GPU memory required for a correct display.

The following examples are for a 1920*1080 screen resolution.

Resolution	Size (GB)	Number of layers	Stereo	Cache size			
				1024 MB	2048 MB	3072 MB	4096 MB
5000*5000	14.4	13	✗	-	✓	✓	✓
10000*10000	15.3	2	✗	✓	✓	✓	✓
2000*2000	1	4	✗	✓	✓	✓	✓
2000*2000	6.51	21	✗	-	-	✓	✓
2400*2400	9.92	6	✓	-	✓	✓	✓
2048*2048	14.4	30	✓	-	-	✓	✓
5000*5000	28.8	26	✗	-	-	-	✓
5000*5000	57.7	26	✓	-	-	-	-

Network and Access Requirements for VR Lab in Multiscreen

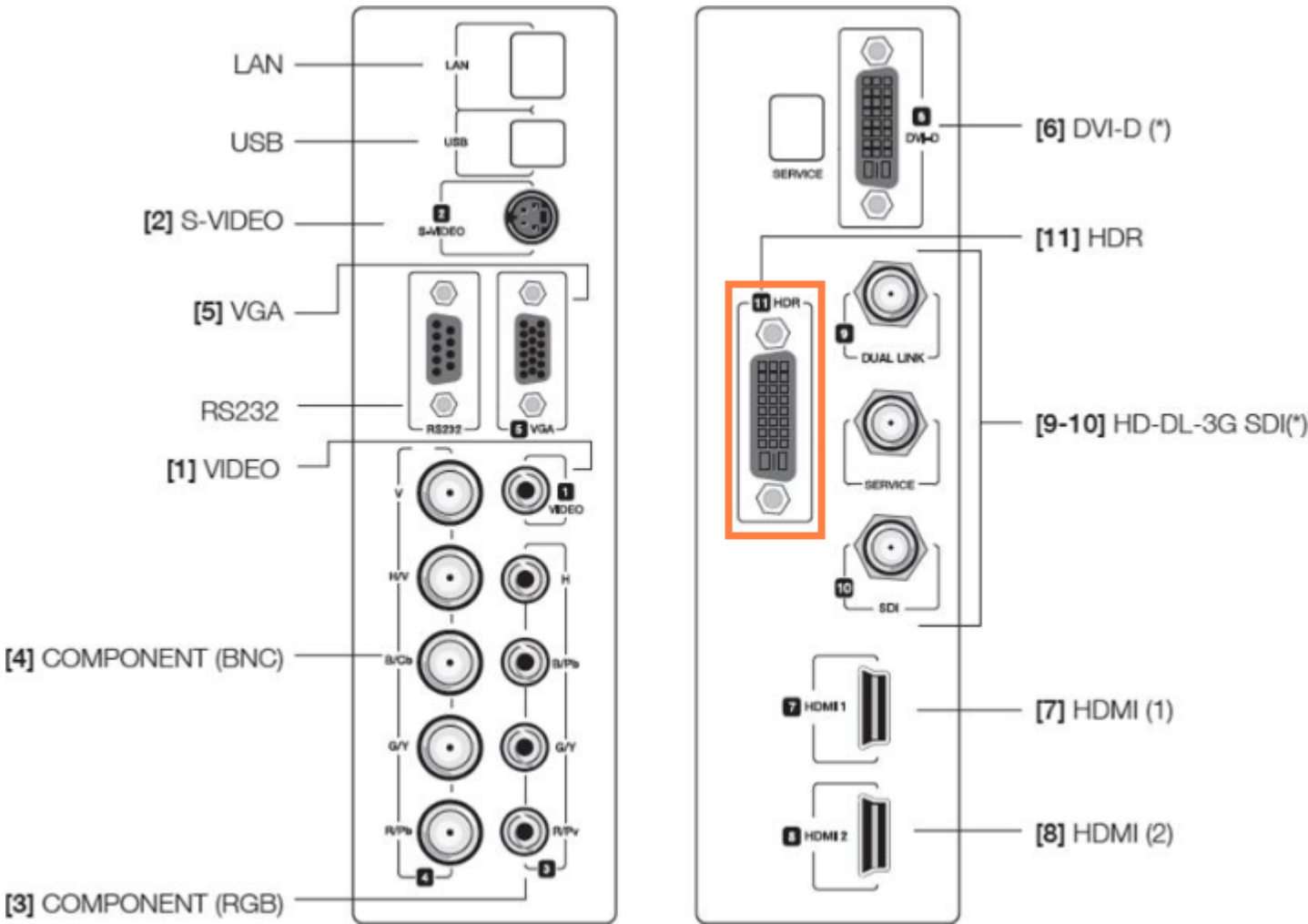
- Port 51008 must be available for the OPTIS Daemon in TCP.
- Port 51004 must be available for Virtual Reality Lab in TCP.
- Port 51005 must be available for Virtual Reality Lab in multicast UDP.
- Maximal Transmission Unit value must be set to default value (1500 bytes).

SIM2 HDR monitor for Virtual Reality Lab

- HDR47 Series monitor
- SIM2 HDR monitor has to be dedicated for rendering and a standard monitor for interface.
- High Dynamic Range DVI signal connector (#11).

Note:

Press F1 key on the remote control to activate the HDRI mode. See your SIM2 HDR display user manual for more information.



1.5.9. Ansys Thermal Desktop and Sinda Software Requirements

For additional information on Ansys Thermal Desktop and Sinda Requirements, see [Thermal Desktop Installation and Licensing Guide](#)

1.6. Third-Party Software and other Security Considerations

The following third-party products are used as part of the installation process. In order for the installation to work properly, you must allow access to these products.

Product Name	Executable Name
Tcl	tcsh.exe
Tk	want.exe
Perl	perl.exe
7zip	7z.exe
Microsoft .NET Framework	.net